in terms of the human development index (HDI), an attempt has been made to examine the interrelations between different parameters of the HDI.

From the domestic angle, the chapter focuses on trends in social-sector spending both at the centre and the state levels. It looks at social-sector policies implemented by the government, particularly poverty alleviation and employment generation, health, education, rural infrastructure, development of the weaker sections of society, women and child development, and social security. It also discusses climate change and its impact on development in the context of intergenerational equity.

## HUMAN & GENDER DEVELOPMENT

The widely quoted document to know about India's 'Human' and 'Gender' related situations is the HDR released by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP). The ***Human Development Report-2013*** of the UNDP, released on *March 14, 2013*, puts India's HDI value for the last year at 0.554, placing it in the *medium human development category* (which it shares with *Equatorial Guinea*). India has been ranked **136** among 187 countries evaluated for human development index (HDI) – a measure for assessing progress in 'life expectancy', 'access to knowledge' and a decent 'standard of living' or 'gross national income per capita (at PPP)'. Some of the highlights of the HDR-2013 about India may be seen as given below:

- On the positive side, India's HDI value went up from 0.345 to 0.554 *between 1980 and 2012*, an increase of *61 per cent* or an average annual increase of 1.5 per cent.
- Despite India's progress, its HDI of 0.554 is below the average of 0.64 for countries in the medium human development group, and of 0.558 for countries in South Asia.
- From South Asia, countries which are close to India's HDI rank and population size are Bangladesh and Pakistan with HDIs ranked 146 each. But the report points out that the ranking masks inequality in the distribution of human development across the population.
- Life expectancy at birth increased by 10.5 years, mean years of schooling by 2.5 years and expected years of schooling by 4.4 years